“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 15

A Brief Description of the Boyhood Pastimes

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In the fifteenth chapter the Lord studies grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, becomes expert in the *Pañjī-ṭīkā* and forbids His mother to eat grains on Ekādaśī. He tells a story: Viśvarūpa, having taken sannyāsa, called Him to take sannyāsa too, but He did not listen and said He wished to serve His parents — and so Viśvarūpa sent Him back home. The departure of Purandara Miśra[3] from this world, the marriage to Lakṣmī-devī, daughter of Vallabhācārya, and other events are described in brief.

*By worshipping Gaura even the evil-minded gains a good mind — (*Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, *vilāsa* 7, verse 1)*

কুমনাঃ সুমনস্ত্বং হি যাতি যস্য পদাব্জয়োঃ ।
সুমনোঽর্পণমাত্রেণ তং চৈতন্যপ্রভুং ভজে ॥ ১ ॥

ku-manāḥ su-manastvaṁ hi
one of evil mind goodness of mind surely
yāti yasya padābjayoḥ
attains at whose lotus feet
su-mano-’rpaṇa-mātreṇa
of flowers by the offering merely
taṁ caitanya-prabhuṁ bhaje
to that Caitanya Prabhu I worship

1 “I worship Caitanya Prabhu. The mere offering of flowers at His lotus feet turns even an evil mind into a good one.” (Hari-bhakti-vilāsa, 7.1)[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One need only offer *sumanas* (jasmine flowers) at His lotus feet, and even a person of evil mind (*ku-manāḥ*) gains a good mind (*sumanas*)[4]. That Caitanya Prabhu I worship.

Anubhāṣya.

ku-manāḥ (one whose mind is absorbed in objects other than Kṛṣṇa) **yasya** (of Caitanya-deva) **padābjayoḥ** (at the lotus feet) **su-mano-’rpaṇa-mātreṇa** (merely by offering *sumanas*, flowers, or else one’s own mind that is *su*, good, intent on serving Kṛṣṇa) **su-manastvaṁ** (a nature free of other desires, not covered by jñāna, karma and the like, and devoted to serving Kṛṣṇa, *kṛṣṇānuśīlana*) **hi** (certainly) **yāti** (attains), **taṁ caitanya-prabhum ahaṁ vande**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র, জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaitacandra, jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

*Among the pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age, the pastime of study is the chief —*

পৌগণ্ড-লীলার সূত্র করিয়ে গণন ।
পৌগণ্ড-বয়সে প্রভুর মুখ্য অধ্যয়ন ॥ ৩ ॥

paugaṇḍa-līlāra sūtra kariye gaṇana
of the boyhood pastimes an outline I make enumeration
paugaṇḍa-vayase prabhura mukhya adhyayana
in the boyhood years the Lord’s chief (pastime) study

3 Now I shall give a brief account of the Lord's boyhood pastimes. In those years His chief occupation was study.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Mukhya adhyayana: His chief activity was the pastime of study.

*The Lord's very extensive pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age —*

পৌগণ্ডলীলা চৈতন্যকৃষ্ণস্যাতিসুবিস্তৃতা ।
বিদ্যারম্ভমুখা পাণিগ্রহণান্তা মনোহরা ॥ ৪ ॥

paugaṇḍa-līlā caitanya-
the boyhood pastimes of Caitanya-
kṛṣṇasyāti-suvistṛtā
Kṛṣṇa very extensive
vidyārambha-mukhā pāṇi-
with the beginning of learning as their start hand-
grahaṇāntā mano-harā
taking (marriage) as their end enchanting

4 "The boyhood pastimes of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa are vast and enchanting. They begin with His first lessons and end with His marriage."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The charming pastimes of the *paugaṇḍa* age (boyhood) of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, from the beginning of His schooling to His marriage, are very extensive.

Anubhāṣya.

caitanya-kṛṣṇasya (of Bhagavān Viśvambhara, whose form is non-different from Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa) **vidyārambha-mukhā** (those whose beginning is the start of schooling) **pāṇi-grahaṇāntā** (and whose end, conclusion, is His marriage) **mano-harā** (captivating all hearts) **paugaṇḍa-līlā** (*paugaṇḍa* is the period from the fifth year to the tenth; the pastimes in that period) **ati-suvistṛtā** (are very extensive).

Studying grammar with Paṇḍita Gaṅgādāsa —

গঙ্গাদাস পণ্ডিত-স্থানে পড়েন ব্যাকরণ ।
শ্রবণ-মাত্রে কণ্ঠে কৈল সূত্রবৃত্তিগণ ॥ ৫ ॥

gaṅgādāsa paṇḍita-sthāne paḍena vyākaraṇa
Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita's at the place He studies grammar
śravaṇa-mātre kaṇṭhe kaila sūtra-vṛtti-gaṇa
by hearing merely in His throat He held the sūtras and commentaries all

5 He studied grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita, and as soon as He heard the sūtras and their commentaries, He knew them all by heart.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
First He received His elementary education from Viṣṇu and Sudarśana, and then He studied grammar with Gaṅgādāsa Paṇḍita.

Mastery within a short time —

অল্পকালে হৈলা পঞ্জী-টীকাতে প্রবীণ ।
চিরকালের পড়ুয়া জিনে হইয়া নবীন ॥ ৬ ॥

alpa-kāle hailā pañjī-ṭīkāte pravīṇa
in a short time He became in the Pañjī-ṭīkā expert
cira-kālera paḍuyā jine haiyā navīna
of long standing the students He defeats being new

6 Within a short time He mastered the *Pañjī-ṭīkā*, and, young as He was, He defeated students who had studied for years.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Pañjī-ṭīkā: there was a well-known commentary on grammar called the *Pañjī-ṭīkā*, and Mahāprabhu composed glosses (*ṭippanī*) on it.

অধ্যয়ন-লীলা প্রভুর দাস-বৃন্দাবন ।
'চৈতন্যমঙ্গলে' কৈল বিস্তারিত বর্ণন ॥ ৭ ॥

adhyayana-līlā prabhura dāsa-vṛndāvana
of study the pastimes of the Lord Vṛndāvana dāsa
'caitanya-maṅgale' kaila vistārita varṇana
in the 'Caitanya-maṅgala' made detailed description

7 In the *Caitanya-maṅgala* Vṛndāvana dāsa has described in detail the Lord's pastimes as a student.[2]

Anubhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapters 4, 6, 7, 8, 9 and 10.

এক দিন মাতার পদে করিয়া প্রণাম ।
প্রভু কহে, — মাতা, মোরে দেহ এক দান ॥ ৮ ॥

eka dina mātāra pade kariyā praṇāma
one day at His mother's feet making obeisance
prabhu kahe, — mātā, more deha eka dāna
the Lord says — Mother, to Me give one gift

8 One day the Lord bowed at His mother's feet and said, "Mother, grant Me one gift."

He leads Mother Śacī to keep the Ekādaśī vow —

মাতা বলে, — তাই দিব, যা তুমি মাগিবে ।
প্রভু কহে, — একাদশীতে অন্ন না খাইবে ॥ ৯ ॥

mātā bale, — tāi diba, yā tumi māgibe
the mother says — that I will give whatever You will ask
prabhu kahe, — ekādaśīte anna nā khāibe
the Lord says — on Ekādaśī grain not you will eat

9 "I will give You whatever You ask," said His mother, and the Lord replied, "Do not eat grain on Ekādaśī."

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu in the *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 299): "In the *Skanda Purāṇa*: 'One who eats on Ekādaśī is a killer of his mother, a killer of his father, a killer of his brother and a killer of his guru; he falls from Viṣṇuloka.' Here fasting (*nirāhāratva*) for Vaiṣṇavas means only giving up the mahā-prasāda grain (*anna*), since eating anything else is always forbidden to them. In the *Agni Purāṇa*: 'One should not eat on Ekādaśī; this vow is the great vow of the Vaiṣṇavas.' This shows, first of all, that it is obligatory even for a non-Vaiṣṇava."

Vaiṣṇavas never accept anything but mahā-prasāda, on any day or at any time. But on the day of Ekādaśī, giving up mahā-prasāda is precisely what is called "fasting" (*upavāsa*).

শচী কহে, — না খাইব, ভালই কহিলা ।
সেই হৈতে একাদশী করিতে লাগিলা ॥ ১০ ॥

śacī kahe, — nā khāiba, bhālai kahilā
Śacī says — not I will eat, well indeed You have spoken
sei haite ekādaśī karite lāgilā
from then on Ekādaśī to observe she began

10 Śacī said, “I will not eat it. You have spoken well.” And from that day on she observed Ekādaśī.

A bride is sought for Viśvarūpa —

তবে মিশ্র বিশ্বরূপের দেখিয়া যৌবন ।
কন্যা মাগি’ বিবাহ দিতে কৈল মন ॥ ১১ ॥

tabe miśra viśvarūpera dekhiyā yauvana
then Miśra of Viśvarūpa seeing the youth
kanyā māgi’ vivāha dite kaila mana
a bride seeking, marriage to give made up his mind

11 Then Miśra, seeing that Viśvarūpa had come of age, resolved to find Him a bride and see Him married.

Viśvarūpa accepts sannyāsa —

বিশ্বরূপ শুনি’ ঘর ছাড়ি’ পলাইলা ।
সন্ন্যাস করিয়া তীর্থ করিবারে গেলা ॥ ১২ ॥

viśvarūpa śuni’ ghara chāḍi’ palāilā
Viśvarūpa hearing, home leaving fled
sannyāsa kariyā tīrtha karibāre gelā
sannyāsa taking, pilgrimage to make He went

12 When Viśvarūpa heard of this, He fled from home. He took sannyāsa and set out on pilgrimage to the holy places.

The grief of Śacī and Miśra; the Lord consoles them —

শুনি' শচী-মিশ্রের দুঃখী হৈল মন ।
তবে প্রভু মাতা-পিতার কৈল আশ্বাসন ॥ ১৩ ॥

śuni' śacī-miśrera duḥkhī haila mana
hearing, of Śacī and Miśra sorrowful became the hearts
tabe prabhu mātā-pitāra kaila āśvāsana
then the Lord mother and father made consolation

13 The news filled the hearts of Śacī and Miśra with sorrow, and the Lord set about consoling His mother and father.

When a son takes sannyāsa to serve Kṛṣṇa, the families of his mother and father are delivered —

ভাল হৈল, — বিশ্বরূপ সন্ন্যাস করিল ।
পিতৃকূল মাতৃকূল, — দুই উদ্ধারিল ॥ ১৪ ॥

bhāla haila, — viśvarūpa sannyāsa karila
good it is — Viśvarūpa sannyāsa has taken
pitṛkūla mātṛkūla, — dui uddhārila
the father's line, the mother's line — both He has delivered

14 "It is well that Viśvarūpa has taken sannyāsa: He has delivered both His father's line and His mother's.

Consoled by the Lord, His parents are content —

আমি ত' করিব তোমা' দুঁহার সেবন ।
শুনিয়া সন্তুষ্ট হৈল পিতামাতার মন ॥ ১৫ ॥

āmi ta' kariba tomā' duṁhāra sevana
I indeed will do of you both service
śuniyā santuṣṭa haila pitāmātāra mana
hearing content became of the father and mother the hearts

15 "And I Myself will serve you both." Hearing this, His father and mother were content at heart.

The Lord loses consciousness —

একদিন নৈবেদ্য-তাম্বূল খাইয়া ।
ভূমিতে পড়িলা প্রভু অচেতন হঞা ॥ ১৬ ॥

ekadina naivedya-tāmbūla khāiyā
one day offered betel having eaten
bhūmite paḍilā prabhu acetana hañā
to the ground fell the Lord unconscious becoming

16 One day, after chewing betel that had been offered to the Deity, the Lord fell to the ground unconscious.

The meeting with Viśvarūpa and their conversation about the Lord's sannyāsa —

আস্তে-ব্যস্তে পিতা-মাতা মুখে দিল পানি ।
সুস্থ হঞা কহে প্রভু অপূর্ব্ব কাহিনী ॥ ১৭ ॥

āste-vyaste pitā-mātā mukhe dila pāni
in haste father and mother on His face put water
sustha hañā kahe prabhu apūrva kāhinī
recovering tells the Lord a wondrous tale

17 His father and mother hastily sprinkled water on His face, and when He came to Himself, the Lord told them a wondrous tale.

এথা হৈতে বিশ্বরূপ মোরে লঞা গেলা ।
সন্ন্যাস করহ তুমি' আমারে কহিলা ॥ ১৮ ॥

ethā haite viśvarūpa more lañā gelā
from here Viśvarūpa Me taking went
sannyāsa karaha tumi' āmāre kahilā
sannyāsa take You to Me He said

18 "Viśvarūpa took Me away from here and said to Me, 'You must take sannyāsa.'

আমি কহি, — আমার অনাথ পিতা-মাতা ।
আমি বালক, — সন্ন্যাসের কিবা জানি কথা ॥ ১৯ ॥

āmi kahi, — āmāra anātha pitā-mātā
I said — My helpless father and mother
āmi bālaka, — sannyāsera kibā jāni kathā
I am a boy — of sannyāsa what do I know the matter

19 "I answered, 'My father and mother have no one to look after them, and I am still a boy — what do I know of sannyāsa?

গৃহস্থ হইয়া করি পিতৃ-মাতৃ-সেবন ।
ইহাতে সন্তুষ্ট হবেন লক্ষ্মী-নারায়ণ ॥ ২০ ॥

gṛhastha haiyā kari pitṛ-mātṛ-sevana
a householder being I will do father's and mother's service
ihāte santuṣṭa habena lakṣmī-nārāyaṇa
by this pleased will be Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa

20 " 'As a householder I shall serve My father and mother, and this will please Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa.'

তবে বিশ্বরূপ ইঁহা পাঠাইল মোরে ।
মাতাকে কহিলা কোটি কোটি নমস্কারে ॥ ২১ ॥

tabe viśvarūpa iṁhā pāṭhāila more
then Viśvarūpa here sent Me
mātāke kahilā koṭi koṭi namaskāre
to Mother He sent word millions upon millions of obeisances

21 "Then Viśvarūpa sent Me back here and asked Me to convey His obeisances to Mother, millions upon millions of them."

এইমত নানা লীলা করে গৌরহরি ।
কি কারণে লীলা, — ইহা বুঝিতে না পারি ॥ ২২ ॥

ei mata nānā līlā kare gaurahari
in this way various pastimes does Gaurahari
ki kāraṇe līlā, — ihā bujhite nā pāri
for what reason the pastimes — this to understand not I can

22 Thus Gaurahari revels in many pastimes, and why He does so, I cannot understand.

Miśra's departure —

কতদিন রহি' মিশ্র গেলা পরলোক ।
মাতা-পুত্র দুঁহার বাড়িল হৃদি শোক ॥ ২৩ ॥

kata dina rahi' miśra gelā para-loka
some days remaining, Miśra went to the next world
mātā-putra duṁhāra bāḍila hṛdi śoka
mother and son of both grew in the heart grief

23 Some time later Miśra left this world, and grief welled up in the hearts of mother and son.

Anubhāṣya.
The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 8): "Some days passed in this way, and then the eternally perfect body of the best of Miśras departed from this world. At Miśra's departure the Lord wept bitterly, as the best of the Raghus wept at Daśaratha's departure. All this is full of the rasa of sorrow; to tell it in detail is painful, so I have told it briefly."

The Lord performs the rites for His father —

বন্ধু-বান্ধব আসি' দুঁহা প্রবোধিল ।
পিতৃক্রিয়া বিধিমতে ঈশ্বর করিল ॥ ২৪ ॥

bandhu-bāndhava āsi' duṁhā prabodhila
friends and kinsmen coming both consoled
pitṛ-kriyā vidhi-mate īśvara karila
the rites for the father according to the injunctions the Lord performed

24 Friends and kinsmen came and consoled them both, and the Lord performed His father's funeral rites as the scriptures enjoin.

The wish to enact the pastimes of household life —

কত দিনে প্রভু চিত্তে করিলা চিন্তন ৷
গৃহস্থ হইলাম, এবে চাহি গৃহধর্ম্ম ॥ ২৫ ॥

kata dine prabhu citte karilā cintana
after some days the Lord in His mind made reflection
gṛhastha hailāma, ebe cāhi gṛha-dharma
a householder I have become, now I want household dharma

25 After a while the Lord thought to Himself, "I have become a householder; now I must take up the duties of household life.

The wife is the home —

গৃহিণী বিনা গৃহধর্ম্ম না হয় শোভন ৷
এত চিন্তি, বিবাহ করিতে হৈল মন ॥ ২৬ ॥

gṛhiṇī vinā gṛha-dharma nā haya śobhana
a wife without household dharma not is graceful
eta cinti, vivāha karite haila mana
thus thinking, marriage to make turned His mind

26 "Yet without a wife household life has no grace." Thinking thus, He set His mind on marriage.

*[Words of *smṛti* (of the Lord?)]*

ন গৃহং গৃহমিত্যাহুর্গৃহিণী গৃহমুচ্যতে ৷
তয়া হি সহিতঃ সর্ব্বান্ পুরুষার্থান্ সমশ্নুতে ॥ ২৭ ॥

na gṛhaṁ gṛham ity āhur
not the house a home thus they call
gṛhiṇī gṛham ucyate
the wife the home is called
tayā hi sahitaḥ sarvān
with her indeed together all
puruṣārthān samaśnute
the goals of life one attains

27 "It is not the house that is called the home; the wife is called the home. Together with her one attains all the goals of life."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

It is not the house that is called "home"; the mistress of the house is called "home." Together with her one will enjoy all the goals of human life (*puruṣārthas*).

Thus ends the fifteenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

gṛham (the dwelling building) **gṛhaṁ na**, **gṛhiṇī** (the mistress who presides over the house, one's partner in *dharma*) **eva gṛham ucyate**. **tayā** (with the wife) **sahitaḥ** (united) (a man) **sarvān puruṣārthān** (all the four goals — dharma, *artha*, *kāma*, *mokṣa* and the rest) **samaśnute** (attains). See the *Mahābhārata*, *Śānti-parva*, Chapter 144, verse 6.

The meeting with Lakṣmī-devī —

দৈবে এক দিন প্রভু পড়িয়া আসিতে।
বল্লভাচার্য্যের কন্যা দেখে গঙ্গা-পথে ॥ ২৮ ॥

daive eka dina prabhu paḍiyā āsite
by providence one day the Lord from study while returning
vallabhācāryera kanyā dekhe gaṅgā-pathe
Vallabhācārya's daughter He sees on the path to the Gaṅgā

28 One day, by providence, as the Lord was coming home from His studies, He saw the daughter of Vallabhācārya on the way to the Gaṅgā.

Vanamālī Paṇḍita as matchmaker —

পূর্ব্বসিদ্ধ ভাব দুঁহার উদয় করিলা ।
দৈবে বনমালী ঘটক শচী-স্থানে আইলা ॥ ২৯ ॥

pūrva-siddha bhāva duṁhāra udaya karilā
perfect from of old the feelings of both arising made
daive vanamālī ghaṭaka śacī-sthāne āilā
by providence Vanamālī the matchmaker to Śacī's house came

29 The love that had been theirs from of old awoke in them both, and, as providence would have it, Vanamālī the matchmaker came to Śacī's house.

Anubhāṣya.

Vanamālī the matchmaker (*ghaṭaka*) was a brāhmaṇa living in Navadvīpa. He arranged Mahāprabhu's marriage. *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (49): "Viśvāmitra, who was the matchmaker at Śrī Rāma's wedding, and the brāhmaṇa whom Rukmiṇī sent to Śrī Keśava — both are now this Vanamālī, who by his deed attained the title of ācārya."

The match and the Lord's marriage to Lakṣmī-devī —

শচীর ইঙ্গিতে সম্বন্ধ করিল ঘটন ।
লক্ষ্মীকে বিবাহ কৈল শচীর নন্দন ॥ ৩০ ॥

śacīra iṅgite sambandha karila ghaṭana
at Śacī's sign the match made arrangement
lakṣmīke vivāha kaila śacīra nandana
Lakṣmī married did Śacī's son

30 At a sign from Śacī he arranged the match, and her son married Lakṣmī.

*The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* describes the *paugaṇḍa* pastimes in detail —*

বিস্তারিয়া বর্ণিলা তাহা বৃন্দাবন-দাস ।
এই ত' পৌগণ্ড-লীলার সূত্র প্রকাশ ॥ ৩১ ॥

vistāriyā varṇilā tāhā vṛndāvana-dāsa
in detail described that Vṛndāvana dāsa
ei ta' paugaṇḍa-līlāra sūtra prakāśa
this indeed of the boyhood pastimes the outline presentation

31 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described all this in detail; here I have set out the boyhood pastimes in outline.

Anubhāṣya.
See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi, Chapter 10. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi, Chapter 8) describes in more detail the sacred-thread ceremony (*upanayana*) and the Lord's gift of gold to His mother.

Thus ends the fifteenth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

পৌগণ্ড-লীলায় লীলা বহু ত' প্রকার ।
বৃন্দাবন-দাস ইহাঁ করিয়াছেন বিস্তার ॥ ৩২ ॥

paugaṇḍa-līlāya līlā bahu ta' prakāra
in the boyhood pastimes pastimes many indeed kinds
vṛndāvana-dāsa ihāṁ kariyāchena vistāra
Vṛndāvana dāsa them has made elaboration

32 The Lord's boyhood holds pastimes of many kinds, and Vṛndāvana dāsa has told them at length.

অতএব দিঙমাত্র ইহাঁ দেখাইল ।
'চৈতন্যমঙ্গলে' সর্ব্বলোকে খ্যাতি হৈল ॥ ৩৩ ॥

ataeva diṅmātra ihāṁ dekhāila
therefore a mere glimpse here I have shown
'caitanya-maṅgale' sarva-loke khyāti haila
through the 'Caitanya-maṅgala' among all people fame came about

33 Therefore I have given here no more than a glimpse of them; through the *Caitanya-maṅgala* they have become famous throughout the world.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ৩৪ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

34 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. A play on words: *sumanas* means both "flower" and "good mind". ↩
2. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). ↩
3. Purandara Miśra is another name of Jagannātha Miśra, the Lord's father. ↩
4. A play on words: *sumanas* means both "flower" and "good mind." ↩